[1] Internet has recently become the greatest market for successful businesses. One of the most inspiring success stories is that of Zoom. It is an American company offering remote video conferencing services. It is based in California and has offices in Europe, Asia and Australia. The story of Zoom has been a journey for its founder Eric Yuan.

[2] Eric Yuan was born and lived in China until he was 27 years old. He got his bachelor's and master's degrees in applied mathematics and computer science from the Shandong University of Science and Technology in his country. He got married at the age of 22.Yuan immigrated to the U.S. in 1997. His visa application was denied 8 times, but he kept persisting. Finally, on the 9th attempt, he was approved, but the process lasted two years.

[3] When Yuan arrived in USA, he started his first job in Silicon Valley as a software engineer at a young company called WebEx. In 2006, Yuan got an MBA (Master of Business Administration) from Stanford Business School and became vice president of Engineering at **the company**. In 2007, Cisco Systems company bought WebEx for $3.2 billion. Yuan wanted to develop new products at Cisco as customers had become dissatisfied with the quality of the services. Yet, he couldn't convince his bosses to let it happen. So, he left Cisco.

[4] In 2011, Yuan started his own company and launched the Zoom platform. "I firmly believed I could develop a platform that would make customers happy. More than 40 fellow engineers followed me in my new venture," he explained. Five years later, Zoom hosted over 20 billion meeting minutes and its customers were 90% of the top 200 U.S. universities.

[5] The breakout of corona virus pandemic in 2019 was a turning point for Zoom. Lockdowns were announced in almost all countries. Companies, schools and colleges started using Zoom Video Communications to conduct business meetings and deliver classes. Zoom offered its basic plan free for all. It also released a paid plan which allows unlimited meetings. Businesses and schools have to pay a subscription fee for the various products the company offers. On top of that, Zoom also makes money from the promotion of hardware products. The company gained over 2.22 million users in the first months of 2020. Currently, Zoom has 504,900 business customers and a value of $9.2 billion.

[6] Zoom, however, is facing a number of challenges. One of them is the fierce competitors such as Skype, Microsoft Teams and Google Meet. Another major issue is the privacy and security problem. Security experts and even the FBI warn that Zoom's default settings aren't secure enough. Apple was forced to remove **the software** from Mac computers last year after a serious security threat.

Adapted from: www.startuptalky.com

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT.

A. FILL IN THE CHART WITH INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (2 pts)

Event/ information	Date/ figure
.....	3.2 billion
.....	2011
Total duration of meetings organized on Zoom platform	.....
The value of Zoom company	.....

B. ARE THESE STATEMENTS TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY. (3 pts)

1. Yuan studied computer science in the US.

.....

2. The American authorities accepted Yuan's visa upon his first application.

.....

3. Yuan developed the Zoom platform in collaboration with others.

.....

C. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS. (3 pts)

1. Why did Yuan want to develop new products at Cisco?

.....

2. Why was 2019 an important year for Zoom?

.....

3. What is the advantage of using paid Zoom services?

.....

D. COMPLETE THE SENTENCES WITH INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (3 pts)

1. To make money from its services, Zoom ……

.....

2. Skype and Microsoft Teams are .....

.....

3. Apple computer company removed Zoom from its computers because of ……

.....

E. CHOOSE THE RIGHT MEANING OF EACH WORD ACCORDING TO THE TEXT. (2 pts)

1. persisting (paragraph 2) means:

a. insisting b. complaining c. assisting

The correct answer: ……

2. fierce (paragraph 6) means:

a. weak b. strong c. unprofessional

The correct answer: ……

F. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (2 pts)

1. the company (paragraph 3): . . . . . .

2. the software (paragraph 6): . . . . . .

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II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

A. FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE CORRECT WORDS FROM THE LISTS. (2 pts)

1. The workers are .....so much noise that I can't concentrate on my homework.

making - taking - doing

2. Can I borrow your umbrella? I can't stand ..... around in the rain.

walk - walking - to walk

3. Don't stop! We have to ..... running to the finish line.

get on - put on - carry on

4. The room..... the party was held is usually used for official meetings.

where - which – whose

B. FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE CORRECT WORDS FROM THE LIST. (1 pt)

natural - risky - non-profit - developing - endangered

Green Planet is a . . . . . organization that aims to save . . . . . animals and protect them in their natural habitats.

C. PUT THE WORDS IN BRACKETS IN THE CORRECT FORM. (2 pts)

1. Most people use the internet for work and (entertain) . . . . . .

2. The local council is thinking of a plan to support (ecology) . . . . . tourism in the area.

D. PUT THE VERBS IN BRACKETS IN THE CORRECT TENSE. (2 pts)

1. Said (surf) . . . . . the net last night when he (come) . . . . . across an interesting article about Morocco.

2. Anas is doing two part-time jobs on the weekend. In three years' time, he (save) . . . . . enough money to travel around Europe.

3. I really miss my friend Jamal. I (not / see) . . . . . him for five years now.

E. REWRITE THE SENTENCES AS SUGGESTED. (4 pts)

1. You can see different types of fish at the Sealife center.

Different types of fish . . . . . .

2. "I will visit my grandparents at the weekend," Amina told her dad.

Amina promised. . . . . .

3. The employees didn't finish their work. They got into trouble.

If . . . . . .

4. Maria lives next door. However, we rarely see each other.

Although. . . . . .

F. CHOOSE THE APPROPRIATE RESPONSES. (2 pts)

1. Bob: I think students shouldn't use artificial intelligence software at school.

Simon: . . . . . .

a. I suppose you're right. b. Yes, let's. c. That's amazing!

2. Leila: Would you like to play golf with me this weekend?

Hind: . . . . . .

a. You're welcome. b. Yes, I agree. c. I'm not sure I can.

G. WHAT WOULD YOU SAY IN THE FOLLOWING SITUATION? (2 pts)

You: (Your friend is always late for the gym. Complain about it.) . . . . . .

. . . . . .

Your friend: (Responds to the complaint.) . . . . . .

WRITING (10 POINTS) DO TASK 1 AND TASK 2

TASK 1: (4 pts)

Complete the following paragraph:

I think the world will look different 30 years from now. For example, most jobs will be done by robots. Another example, ……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

TASK 2: (6 pts)

Write a reply to the following email.

I have a high paying job, but I do not like the boss and the working conditions. I am thinking about leaving it and looking for another one. What do you suggest I should do? I really need your advice.

Jamal

Hi Jamal,

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

……

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Baccalaureate English National Exam Arts June 2023 · Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

A. Fill in the chart with information from the text. (2 pts) **$3.2 billion** → Cisco Systems bought WebEx (in 2007).
2011 → Yuan started his own company and launched the Zoom platform.
Total duration of meetings → over 20 billion minutes.
Value of Zoom → $9.2 billion.

B. Are these statements true or false? Justify. (3 pts)

1. **False.** "He got his bachelor's and master's degrees in applied mathematics and computer science… in his country." (paragraph 2)
2. **False.** "His visa application was denied 8 times." (paragraph 2)
3. **True.** "More than 40 fellow engineers followed me in my new venture." (paragraph 4)

C. Answer these questions. (3 pts)

1. Because customers had become dissatisfied with the quality of the services.
2. Because of the corona virus pandemic: lockdowns made companies, schools and colleges start using Zoom.
3. The paid plan allows unlimited meetings.

D. Complete the sentences with information from the text. (3 pts)

1. charges a subscription fee for its various products (and promotes hardware products).
2. fierce competitors of Zoom.
3. a serious security threat.

E. Choose the right meaning of each word according to the text. (2 pts)

1. a. insisting
2. b. strong

F. What do the underlined words in the text refer to? (2 pts)

1. WebEx
2. Zoom

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

A. Fill in the gaps with the correct words from the lists. (2 pts)

1. making
2. walking
3. carry on
4. where

B. Fill in the gaps with the correct words from the list. (1 pt) non-profit · endangered
C. Put the words in brackets in the correct form. (2 pts) entertainment · ecological
D. Put the verbs in brackets in the correct tense. (2 pts) was surfing · came · will have saved

E. Rewrite the sentences as suggested. (4 pts)

1. Different types of fish **can be seen at the Sealife center**.
2. Amina promised **her dad (that) she would visit her grandparents at the weekend**.
3. If **the employees had finished their work, they wouldn't have got into trouble**.
4. Although **Maria lives next door, we rarely see each other**.

F. Choose the appropriate responses. (2 pts)

1. a. I suppose you're right.
2. c. I'm not sure I can.

G. What would you say in the following situation? (2 pts) You: You're always late for the gym! It's really annoying.
Your friend: I'm sorry. I'll try to be on time from now on.

III. WRITING (10 POINTS; task 1: 4 pts; task 2: 6 pts)

Scoring criteria	Task 1	Task 2
Relevance of content to the task	2 pts	3 pts
Appropriateness and variety of vocabulary	1 pt	2 pts
Grammar and mechanics	1 pt	1 pt

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Task 1: Another example, people will travel in electric and self-driving cars, so there will be fewer accidents and less pollution. In addition, students will study at home with virtual reality, and doctors will use artificial intelligence to treat patients. Finally, many people will live and work on other planets.

Task 2: Hi Jamal, Thanks for your email. I understand your situation, and here is my advice. First, you should talk to your boss about the problems and see if the conditions can improve. Second, don't leave your job before you find a new one, because it is difficult to find a well-paid job. In addition, you could look for offers on the Internet and send your CV to several companies. Finally, think carefully: money is important, but so is your happiness. Good luck! Best wishes,
Samir